

SLOWER THAN YOU CAN PLAY

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #109

Most of us spend a lot of our practice time very efficiently drilling in our bad habits. And then we wonder why jazz is so dang hard and why we aren't progressing quickly enough. Here's a thought - how about if we spent our practice time learning different, better habits instead? Better habits are good, and it's definitely good to practice better. Words to live by.

Most of our misspent practice time gets down to playing things too quickly. Let's slow it down and begin plugging some major holes in our mental and physical technique. Here is an incomplete list of some good questions to ask of yourself as you are playing SLOWLY.

- 1) Timbre/Tone - As you move up and down the instrument, is your tone consistent?
- 2) Volume - Are some notes sticking out due to volume unevenness?
- 3) Even Technique - Are your fingers moving perfectly evenly? Every note of that exercise?
- 4) Good Time - Are you playing in time? Are you moving key to key in time?
- 5) Articulation - Are your articulations and/or accents perfectly uniform?
- 6) Intonation - Are you in tune across all registers?
- 7) Know What You Are Playing - Do you know where you are? Do you know the notes you are playing relative to the key you are in? Get past the patterns. What note are you playing?

#1 - Ascending Minor 7 Chords (up in 1/2 steps)

